10 riskiest scams reported by consumers in 2023

Credit repair/
debt relief

scams appeared
on the list of 10
riskiest scams
for the first time

since we began
publishing the
BBB Scam
Tracker Risk

Report in 2016.

Each year, BBB publishes its list of 10 riskiest scam types (Table 1), which is calculated using the BBB Risk Index and reports submitted to BBB Scam Tracker. In 2023, there were some significant shifts in position on the list.

Investment/cryptocurrency scams became the No. 1 riskiest scam type this year, with 80.4% of those targeted reporting a monetary loss. The reported median dollar loss ($3,800) was the second highest of all scam types.6

In 2023, employment scams remained the second riskiest scam. The percentage of reports for this scam type rose 54.2%, from 9.6% in 2022 to 14.8% in 2023. The reported median dollar loss for employment scams rose 33%, from $1,500 in 2022 to $1,995 in 2023.

Although online purchase scams dropped to third riskiest on our list, these scams continued to have a huge impact, with the highest percentage of reports to BBB Scam Tracker (41.9%) and the second-highest percentage of reports with a monetary loss (susceptibility). More than 82% of those who reported being targeted by online purchase scams lost money. The median dollar loss for this scam type dropped from $100 in 2022 to $71 in 2023.

Romance scams rose on the list from seventh to fifth riskiest. The reported median dollar loss rose from $1,411 in 2022 to $3,600 in 2023. In 2023, 65.7% of romance scam reports included a monetary loss compared to only 16.1% in 2022.

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Risk Report in 2016. The percentage of reports with a monetary loss (susceptibility) for this scam type rose 64.3% from 2022 to 2023. The
median dollar loss rose from $870 to $1,000.

6 This year, we combined cryptocurrency and investment scams into one category because the majority of cryptocurrency scams involve investment scenarios.

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